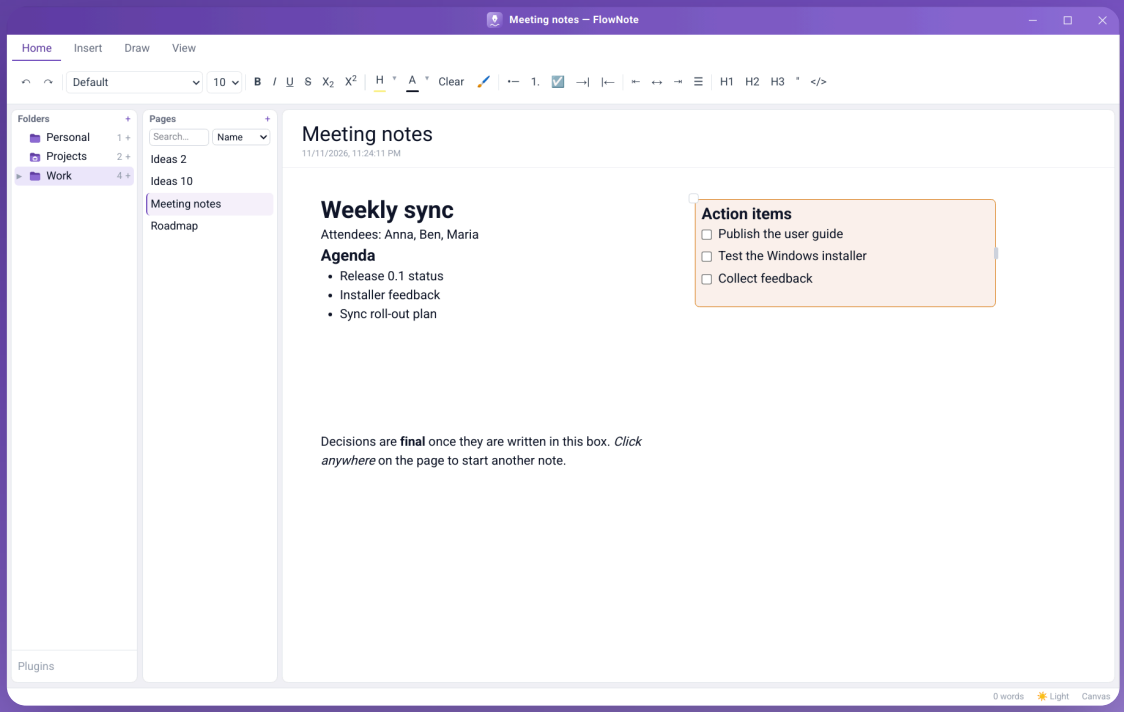
INSTALLATION & USER GUIDE

FlowNote

Install FlowNote on Linux and Windows, then learn every feature step by step: folders, pages, the canvas, formatting, tables, drawing, search, AI, plugins and Backup & Sync.



Version 0.1.0

Linux · Windows

Contents

PART 1 · INSTALLATION

1. Before you start

- 1.1 Which file do I need?
- 1.2 System requirements
- 1.3 Already using FlowNote?
- 1.4 Optional: check the download

2. Installing on Linux

- 2.1 Method A: one-file installer (graphical)
- 2.2 Method B: one-file installer in a terminal
- 2.3 Method C: from the bundle folder
- 2.4 Check that it worked
- 2.5 Where FlowNote is installed

3. Installing on Windows

- 3.1 Method A: setup wizard (recommended)
- 3.2 Method B: MSI package (all users / IT departments)
- 3.3 Method C: unattended install
- 3.4 Check that it worked
- 3.5 Where FlowNote is installed

4. Updating and backing up

- 4.1 Updating to a new version
- 4.2 Backing up your notes

5. Uninstalling

- 5.1 Linux
- 5.2 Windows

6. Solving installation problems

- 6.1 Linux
- 6.2 Windows

PART 2 · USER MANUAL

7. Welcome to FlowNote

- 7.1 Features at a glance

8. A tour of the window

9. Folders and pages

- 9.1 Creating your first page
- 9.2 Folders and sub-folders
- 9.3 Folder icons
- 9.4 Renaming and deleting pages
- 9.5 Natural sort order

10. Writing on the canvas

- 10.1 Click anywhere and type
- 10.2 Moving and resizing segments
- 10.3 Segment colours
- 10.4 Deleting a segment, with Undo
- 10.5 Canvas and Linear mode
- 10.6 Spell check

11. Formatting text

- 11.1 Fonts, text styles and colours
- 11.2 Lists, checklists and alignment
- 11.3 Headings, quotes and code
- 11.4 Format Painter
- 11.5 Clear formatting, Undo and Redo

12. Inserting content

- 12.1 The "/" block menu
- 12.2 Code blocks with syntax highlighting
- 12.3 Tables
- 12.4 Table templates
- 12.5 Pictures and file attachments

13. Drawing and handwriting

14. Finding notes

15. Making FlowNote look the way you like

- 15.1 Light and dark theme
- 15.2 Page colours
- 15.3 Contrast assistant
- 15.4 Zoom and resizable panels
- 15.5 Status bar

16. AI writing assistant

17. Plugins

18. Keeping your notes safe

- 18.1 Where your notes are stored
- 18.2 Backup & Sync
- 18.3 Sync status
- 18.4 Conflict handling
- 18.5 Mass-deletion safeguard

19. Keyboard shortcuts

20. Troubleshooting

21. Frequently asked questions

PART 1

Installation

Download, install, update and uninstall FlowNote. Linux comes first (chapter 2), then Windows (chapter 3).

1. Before you start

1.1 Which file do I need?

Your computer	Download	Size
Linux (64-bit)	`FlowNote-<version>-linux-x86_64.run` : one-file installer (recommended) or `FlowNote-<version>-linux-x86_64.tar.gz` : the same, as a folder	≈ 185 MB
Windows 10 / 11 (64-bit)	`FlowNote-<version>-windows-x64.zip` : setup wizard, MSI package and uninstaller	< 100 MB

Not sure if your computer is 64-bit? On Linux run `uname -m` in a terminal; it should print `x86_64` . On Windows open **Settings** → **System** → **About** and look for *64-bit operating system*.

1.2 System requirements

	Linux	Windows
Operating system	Any 64-bit distribution. The *system-wide* install needs a Debian/Ubuntu-based one (Ubuntu, Debian, Linux Mint, Pop!_OS, elementary…).	Windows 10 or Windows 11, 64-bit
Disk space	≈ 280 MB (system-wide) or ≈ 110 MB (just for me), plus your notes	Less than 100 MB, plus your notes
Permissions	Your password only for the system-wide install	No administrator rights for the setup wizard; the MSI needs them
Other	A desktop session. For graphical installer windows, `zenity` or `kdialog` (most desktops have one)	Microsoft Edge WebView2 (built into Windows 11; added automatically on Windows 10)

1.3 Already using FlowNote?

You don't need to uninstall first. Installing a newer version **upgrades** FlowNote in place and **keeps all your notes**. If you want an extra safety copy, see *Backing up your notes* in chapter 4.

1.4 Optional: check the download

Each download comes with checksums so you can confirm it isn't damaged:

```
# Linux, in the download folder
$ sha256sum -c FlowNote-<version>-linux-x86_64.sha256
FlowNote-<version>-linux-x86_64.run: OK
```

```
# Windows PowerShell — compare with the value in FlowNote-<version>-windows-x64.zip.sha256
PS> Get-FileHash .\FlowNote-<version>-windows-x64.zip -Algorithm SHA256
```

2. Installing on Linux

Choose **one** of the three methods below. Method A is the easiest.

2.1 Method A: one-file installer (graphical)

1. **Download** `FlowNote-<version>-linux-x86_64.run` (for example into your *Downloads* folder).
2. **Allow it to run.** In your file manager, right-click the file → **Properties** → **Permissions** → tick **Allow executing file as program** (in KDE Dolphin: *Is executable*). Close the dialog.
3. **Double-click** the file. If your file manager asks what to do, choose **Run** (not *Display* or *Open in text editor*).
4. **Welcome.** A FlowNote window shows the version being installed. Click **OK**.
5. **Release notice.** Read it and click **Continue** (*Cancel* stops without changing anything).
6. **Choose the install type** and click **OK**:
   - **For everyone on this computer**: a normal system package. You'll be asked for your password in the next step. Recommended on Ubuntu, Debian and Mint.
   - **Just for me**: no password, works on every distribution, installed in your home folder.
7. **Enter your password** if asked (system-wide install only), then wait while a progress window is shown. This takes from a few seconds to a minute.
8. **Finished.** The last window says where FlowNote was installed and asks *Start FlowNote now?* Click **Yes** to open it.

> **Tip**
> From now on, open FlowNote from your application menu: look for **FlowNote** under *Office*, or search for "FlowNote".

2.2 Method B: one-file installer in a terminal

The same installer asks the same questions as text when you run it in a terminal. Type the answer and press `Enter`; pressing `Enter` alone takes the default (marked `*` or written in capitals, like `[Y/n]`).

1. Open a terminal in the download folder (right-click inside the folder → **Open in Terminal**, or `cd ~/Downloads`).
2. Make the installer executable and start it:

```
$ chmod +x FlowNote-*.run
$ ./FlowNote-*.run
```

3. Answer the questions. A typical session looks like this:

```
Welcome to the FlowNote 0.1.0 installer.
...
Continue? [Y/n] y
How do you want to install FlowNote?
  1) * For everyone on this computer (system package, needs your password)
  2)   Just for me (anna), no password needed
Choose 1-2 [default: the one marked *, q to cancel]: 2
==> Copying FlowNote to /home/anna/.local/opt/flownote
==> Adding FlowNote to the app menu
==> FlowNote 0.1.0 is installed for anna (in /home/anna/.local/opt/flownote).
Start FlowNote now? [Y/n] y
```

4. If you chose *For everyone*, type your password when `sudo` asks for it (nothing appears on screen while you type; that's normal).

2.3 Method C: from the bundle folder

Use this if you downloaded the `.tar.gz`, or want to install without any questions (for example on several computers).

1. Unpack the bundle and go into its folder:

```
$ tar xzf FlowNote-<version>-linux-x86_64.tar.gz
$ cd FlowNote-<version>-linux-x86_64
```

2. Run the installer with the options you want:

```
$ ./install.sh                      # guided, like Method B
$ ./install.sh --appimage --silent   # just for me, no questions
$ ./install.sh --deb --silent        # for everyone, no questions (asks for sudo password)
$ ./install.sh --help                # all options
```

Option	Meaning
`--deb`	System-wide install (the `.deb` package)
`--appimage`	Just-for-me install (the AppImage)
`--silent` or `-y`	Don't ask anything; use defaults
`--gui` / `--cli`	Force graphical windows / terminal questions
`--launch` / `--no-launch`	Start (or don't offer to start) FlowNote at the end

> **Note**
> Advanced users can also install the packages directly: `sudo apt install ./FlowNote-<version>-amd64.deb`, or make the `.AppImage` executable and run it. The installer does this for you and also adds the menu entry, the `flownote` command and an uninstaller.

> **Note**
> The "just for me" install is an AppImage, which normally needs the FUSE 2 library to start quickly. If your system doesn't have it, the installer sets FlowNote up to unpack itself on each start instead. That works fine but takes a few seconds longer. For faster starts, run `sudo apt install libfuse2t64` (Ubuntu 24.04 and later; `libfuse2` on older releases), then run the installer again.

2.4 Check that it worked

- ☐ **FlowNote** appears in your application menu.
- ☐ Typing `flownote` in a new terminal starts it. (Just-for-me install: if the command isn't found, log out and in again once, or use `~/.local/bin/flownote`.)
- ☐ FlowNote opens with empty *Folders* and *Pages* panels, or with your existing notes after an upgrade.

2.5 Where FlowNote is installed

	For everyone (.deb)	Just for me (AppImage)
Program	`/opt/FlowNote`	`~/.local/opt/flownote`
Command	`/usr/bin/flownote`	`~/.local/bin/flownote`
Menu entry	System-wide	`~/.local/share/applications`
Uninstaller	`uninstall.sh` in the bundle, or `sudo apt remove flownote`	`~/.local/opt/flownote/uninstall.sh`
Your notes (both)	`~/.config/@flownote/electron/`	

	For everyone (.deb)	Just for me (AppImage)
Install log (both)	`~/.cache/flownote-install.log`	

3. Installing on Windows

Choose **one** method. Method A suits almost everyone.

3.1 Method A: setup wizard (recommended)

1. **Download** `FlowNote-<version>-windows-x64.zip`.
2. **Unzip it.** Right-click the zip → **Extract All…** → **Extract**. A folder with the same name opens.
3. **Start setup.** Double-click `FlowNote_<version>_x64-setup.exe`.
4. **SmartScreen warning.** Preview builds aren't code-signed yet, so Windows may show *"Windows protected your PC"*. Click **More info**, check the app name says FlowNote, then click **Run anyway**.
5. **Language.** Choose English, Deutsch, Français or Español and click **OK**.
6. **Welcome page.** Click **Next**.
7. **Release notice.** Read it and click **I Agree**.
8. **Install location.** Keep the suggested folder (in your user profile, no admin rights needed) or click **Browse…** to choose another. Click **Next**.
9. **Start Menu folder.** Keep *FlowNote* and click **Install**.
10. **Wait** a few seconds while files are copied.
11. **Finish.** Tick **Create desktop shortcut** if you want an icon on the desktop. Leave **Run FlowNote** ticked and click **Finish**.

> **Tip**
> Your **Start Menu** → **FlowNote** folder now contains *FlowNote*, *FlowNote Guide* (this guide) and *Uninstall FlowNote*.

3.2 Method B: MSI package (all users / IT departments)

1. Unzip the download as above.
2. Double-click `FlowNote_<version>_x64_en-US.msi`.
3. Click through the installer: **Next** → accept the release notice → **Next** → **Install**.
4. Click **Yes** when Windows asks for administrator permission (the MSI installs for every user of the PC).
5. Click **Finish**, then open FlowNote from the Start Menu.

3.3 Method C: unattended install

For scripts and managed deployments, open **PowerShell** or **Command Prompt** in the unzipped folder:

```
# per user, no admin, no windows shown
PS> .\FlowNote_<version>_x64-setup.exe /S

# all users (run as administrator)
PS> msiexec /i FlowNote_<version>_x64_en-US.msi /qn /norestart
```

3.4 Check that it worked

- ☐ **FlowNote** appears in the Start Menu (and on the desktop, if you chose a shortcut).
- ☐ **Settings** → **Apps** → **Installed apps** lists *FlowNote* with the version you installed.
- ☐ FlowNote opens with empty *Folders* and *Pages* panels, or with your existing notes after an upgrade.

3.5 Where FlowNote is installed

	Setup wizard	MSI
Program	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\FlowNote` (unless you changed it)	`C:\Program Files\FlowNote`
Your notes (both)	`%APPDATA%\com.sandeep.flownote\`	

4. Updating and backing up

4.1 Updating to a new version

1. Close FlowNote (the installer also closes it for you if it's running).
2. Download the new version and install it exactly as described above, using the **same install type** as before.
   - Linux: the installer says *"FlowNote x is installed. Upgrade it to y?"*; answer **Yes**.
   - Windows: run the new setup wizard; it replaces the old version.
3. Open FlowNote. Your folders and pages are all still there.

Running the installer for the version you already have offers to **repair** it, which fixes a damaged install without touching your notes.

4.2 Backing up your notes

1. Close FlowNote.
2. Copy the whole notes folder to a USB drive or another safe place:
   - Linux: `~/.config/@flownote/electron/` (in the file manager press `Ctrl` + `H` to show hidden folders)
   - Windows: type `%APPDATA%\com.sandeep.flownote` into the File Explorer address bar
3. To restore, close FlowNote and copy the folder back to the same place.

For automatic, encrypted backups across computers, set up **Backup & Sync** (chapter *Keeping your notes safe* in Part 2).

5. Uninstalling

> **Important**
> Uninstalling removes the program but **keeps your notes** unless you choose to delete them. Reinstalling later brings them back automatically.

5.1 Linux

1. Close FlowNote.

2. Start the uninstaller. Any one of:
   - Double-click `uninstall.sh` in the unpacked bundle folder (choose **Run**).
   - Just-for-me install: run `~/.local/opt/flownote/uninstall.sh` (works without the download).
   - In a terminal in the bundle folder: `./uninstall.sh`
3. **Confirm** that you want to remove FlowNote.
4. **Choose what happens to your notes**: answer **No** to keep them (default), or **Yes** to delete them permanently.
5. Enter your password if asked (system-wide install only). A final message confirms that FlowNote is uninstalled.

```
$ ./uninstall.sh --keep-data      # remove FlowNote, keep notes, no questions about them
$ ./uninstall.sh --remove-data    # remove FlowNote and delete notes
$ sudo apt remove flownote        # system-wide install only, keeps notes
```

5.2 Windows

1. Close FlowNote.
2. Open **Start** → **FlowNote** → **Uninstall FlowNote**, or **Settings** → **Apps** → **Installed apps**, click ⋯ next to FlowNote and choose **Uninstall**.
3. On the confirmation page, tick **Delete the application data** only if you also want to delete your notes.
4. Click **Uninstall**, then **Close** when it's done.

Alternatively, double-click **Uninstall FlowNote.cmd** in the unzipped download folder. It finds either kind of install (wizard or MSI) and shows a small window with an *Also delete my notes* checkbox. For scripts:

```
PS> powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\Uninstall-FlowNote.ps1 -Silent -KeepData
PS> powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\Uninstall-FlowNote.ps1 -Silent -RemoveData
```

6. Solving installation problems

6.1 Linux

Problem	Solution
Double-clicking the `.run` file opens a text editor or does nothing	It isn't executable yet: see Method A step 2, or run `chmod +x FlowNote-*.run`. Some file managers need you to pick **Run** or **Execute** when asked.
No installer windows appear, only terminal questions	Neither `zenity` nor `kdialog` is installed. Answer in the terminal, or install one: `sudo apt install zenity`.
"These packages are built for 64-bit PCs"	FlowNote currently needs an x86_64 computer; ARM devices (e.g. Raspberry Pi) aren't supported yet.
The system-wide install fails	Check your password and that no other update/software centre is running, then try again. Or choose **Just for me**. Details are in `~/.cache/flownote-install.log`.
"The system install needs apt"	Your distribution isn't Debian/Ubuntu-based. Use the **Just for me** install.
Note about FUSE 2 during install; FlowNote starts slowly	Optional speed-up: `sudo apt install libfuse2t64` (Ubuntu 24.04+) or `libfuse2` (older), then run the installer again.

Problem	Solution
`flownote: command not found`	Just-for-me install: log out and back in, or run `~/.local/bin/flownote`. FlowNote is also in the app menu.

6.2 Windows

Problem	Solution
"Windows protected your PC"	Click **More info** → **Run anyway**. Preview installers aren't code-signed yet.
Setup says FlowNote is running	Close FlowNote (check Task Manager if no window is open), or let setup close it, then continue.
The MSI asks for an administrator	The MSI installs for all users. Use the setup wizard instead for a per-user install without admin rights.
Antivirus blocks the installer	Make sure the file came from the official download and its checksum matches, then allow it in your antivirus.
FlowNote doesn't start on Windows 10	Install Microsoft Edge WebView2 Runtime from microsoft.com, then start FlowNote again.
`Uninstall-FlowNote.ps1` "cannot be loaded because running scripts is disabled"	Use **Uninstall FlowNote.cmd**, or start PowerShell with `-ExecutionPolicy Bypass` as shown above.

Still stuck? Open an issue at `github.com/sandeep12biswas/noteApp` and attach `~/.cache/flownote-install.log` (Linux) or a screenshot of the error (Windows).

PART 2

User manual

Every FlowNote feature: what it does, how to use it step by step, and what it looks like.

7. Welcome to FlowNote

FlowNote is a note-taking app with a free-form canvas. Click anywhere on a page and start writing: there are no fixed lines or boxes to fight with. It runs on Linux and Windows, works fully offline, and can keep your devices in sync with end-to-end encryption.

Notes are organised the way you'd organise a binder:

- **Folders** (left panel) hold related pages, and can contain sub-folders.
- **Pages** (middle panel) are the notes inside the selected folder.
- **The editor** (right) is the page itself: a canvas where every click on an empty spot starts a new block of text called a *segment*.

Everything is saved automatically as you type. There is no Save button.

> **What's new**
>
> - **Tables.** Insert a table from the "/" menu or *Insert* → *Table*, type with `Tab` between cells, and add or remove rows and columns from the ribbon. The header row is coloured and always readable.
> - **Table templates.** Save a table's layout (and optionally its contents) as a template, then insert it anywhere, including by typing `/table` and its name.
> - **Many more colours.** The Page colour and segment colour menus offer a grid of shades for ten colour families, your recently used colours, and a built-in colour wheel under *More colours*….
> - **Delete a segment directly** from its right-click menu, with a few seconds to *Undo*.
> - **Page names can start with a lowercase letter**, and keep the case you type.
> - **Shaded table rows.** Table rows alternate between two tints of the header colour. Choose another shading colour, turn it off, or give any row its own colour with *Insert* → *Rows* ▾.
> - **A softer look.** The folder, page and editor panels are rounded cards, menus, dialogs, notes and tables have rounded corners, and the app name sits in the middle of the title bar. On Linux the window's own corners are rounded too.

7.1 Features at a glance

Area	Features
Organising	Folders and sub-folders, folder icons, page counts, natural sort, drag to reorganise
Writing	Click-anywhere canvas, segments (move, resize, colour, delete with Undo), Linear mode, spell check
Formatting	Fonts, text styles, highlight and text colour, lists and checklists, headings, quotes, Format Painter
Inserting	"/" block menu, code blocks with highlighting, tables with shaded rows and table templates, pictures and file attachments
Drawing	Pen, marker and eraser in five colours
Finding	Search by page name or by contents
Appearance	Light/dark theme, page colours with shades and a colour wheel, contrast assistant, zoom
AI	Draft text with Claude, Gemini, OpenAI, or a local model through Ollama
Plugins	New block types, such as the Spreadsheet plugin
Sync	End-to-end encrypted Backup & Sync via OneDrive, Google Drive or any folder

8. A tour of the window

When you start FlowNote for the first time the window is empty. You'll create your first folder and page in the next chapter.

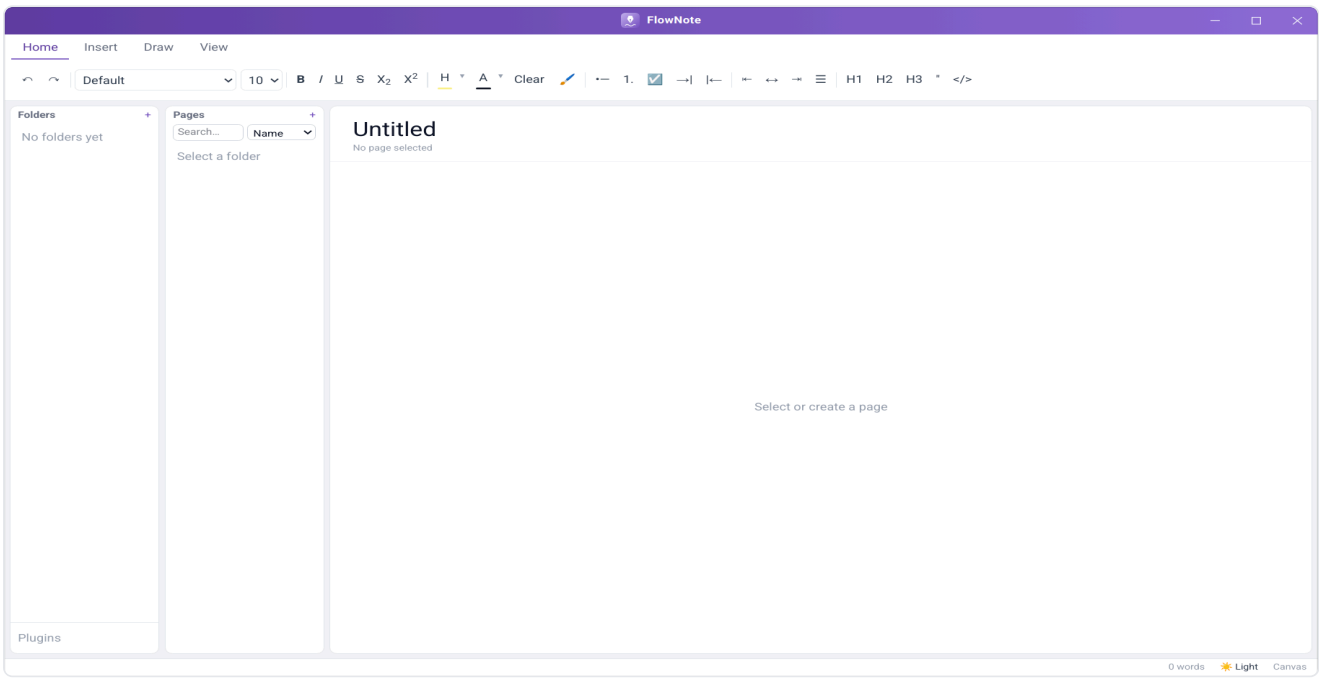


Figure: FlowNote on first launch

Once you have some notes, the window looks like this:

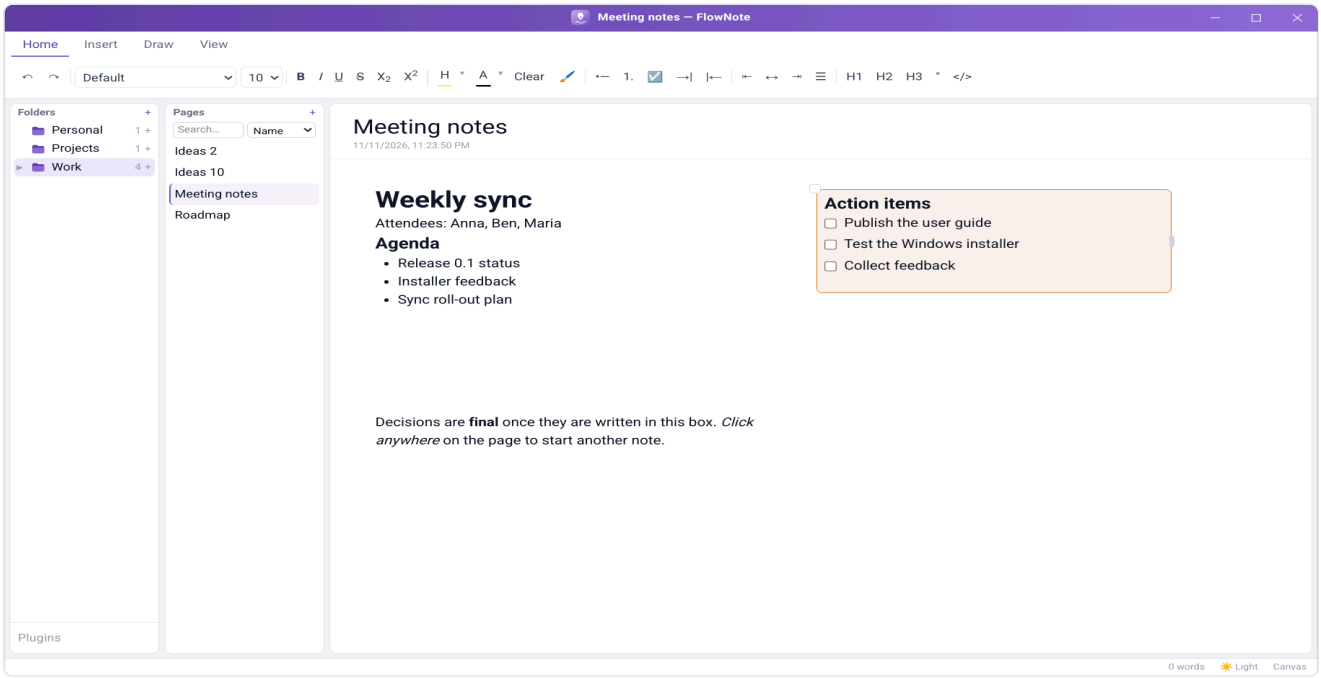


Figure: The main window

Area	What it's for
Ribbon (top)	Tabs of tools: *Home* (text formatting), *Insert* (tables, AI), *Draw* (ink), *View* (zoom, page colour, sync).
Folders panel (left)	Your folders and sub-folders, each with a count of its pages. *Plugins* at the bottom opens the Plugin Manager.

Area	What it's for
Pages panel (middle)	The pages in the selected folder, a **+** button for a new page, and search.
Editor (right)	The page title and date, and the canvas you write on.
Status bar (bottom)	Sync status, the theme switch (System / Light / Dark), and the editing mode (Canvas / Linear).

Drag the thin borders between the panels to make them wider or narrower.

9. Folders and pages

9.1 Creating your first page

What it does. The middle panel lists the pages in the selected folder. Creating a page always asks where it belongs first, so pages never end up loose.

How to use it.

1. Click **+** next to *Pages* (or right-click an empty part of a panel and choose **New page**).
2. Choose **New folder** and type a folder name, or choose **Existing folder** and pick one. Click **Next**.
3. Type the page name and click **Create**.

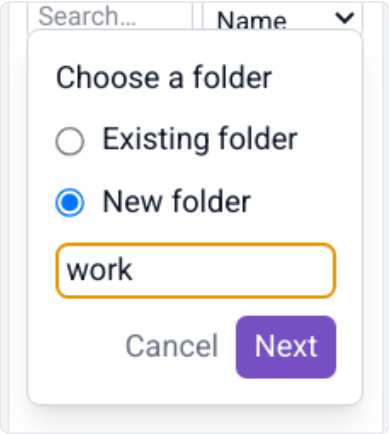


Figure: Step 2: choose or create a folder

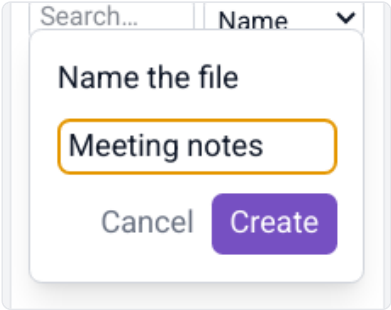


Figure: Step 3: name the page

> **Note**
> Page names must start with a letter, lowercase or capital (not a number or symbol), and keep the case you type: *meeting notes* stays *meeting notes*. Folder names are capitalised for you as you type: *work* becomes *Work*. The same page name can be used in different folders.

9.2 Folders and sub-folders

What it does. The left panel shows only folders, never pages, so the structure of your notebook is always visible at a glance. Each folder shows how many pages it holds. Folders can contain sub-folders up to 7 levels deep; folders with sub-folders get an arrow to expand or collapse them.

How to use it.

- **New folder:** click **+** next to *Folders*, type a name, press `Enter`.
- **Sub-folder:** hover over a folder and click its small **+**, or right-click the folder and choose **New subfolder**.

- **Move a folder:** drag it onto another folder, or onto empty space to make it a top-level folder.
- **Rename or delete:** right-click the folder. Deleting a folder deletes the pages inside it, so you're asked to confirm.

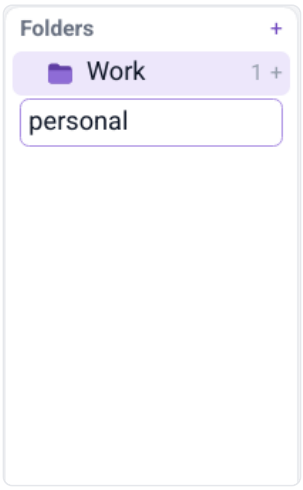


Figure: Typing a new folder name

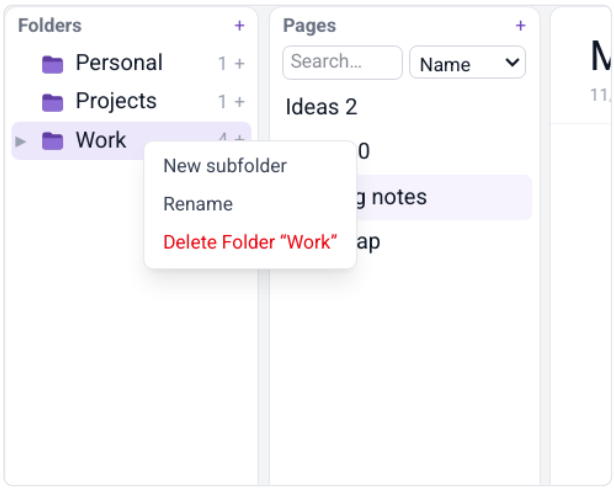


Figure: Right-click a folder for more actions

9.3 Folder icons

What it does. Gives each folder its own icon so you can find it quickly: briefcase for work, house for home, lightbulb for ideas.

How to use it. Click a folder's icon and pick one. **Lavender** icons match FlowNote's colours (a lavender folder with a symbol on it); **Emoji** are the colourful alternatives. *Default* restores the plain lavender folder.

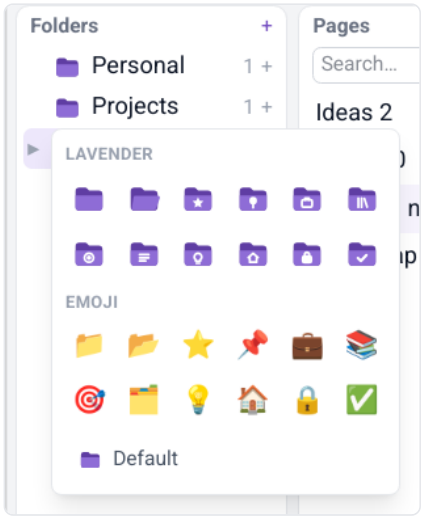


Figure: The folder icon picker

9.4 Renaming and deleting pages

What it does. Pages are named when you create them and can be renamed or removed at any time.

How to use it. To rename a page, edit its title at the top of the editor. To delete it, right-click it in the Pages panel and choose **Delete**, then confirm.

9.5 Natural sort order

What it does. Folders and pages are sorted the way people count, so *Ideas 2* comes before *Ideas 10*.

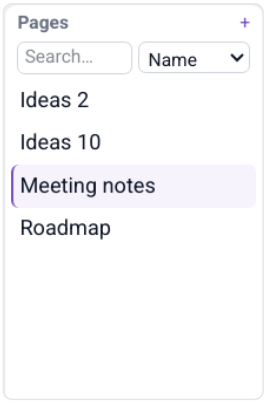


Figure: Pages sorted naturally

10. Writing on the canvas

10.1 Click anywhere and type

What it does. Each page is an open canvas. Clicking an empty spot creates a **segment**, a text box, exactly where you clicked. Lay out notes the way you think: side-by-side columns, a to-do list in the corner, a summary at the bottom.

How to use it.

1. Click any empty spot on the page. A new segment appears there.
2. Click inside the segment and start typing.
3. Click somewhere else on the page to start another segment.

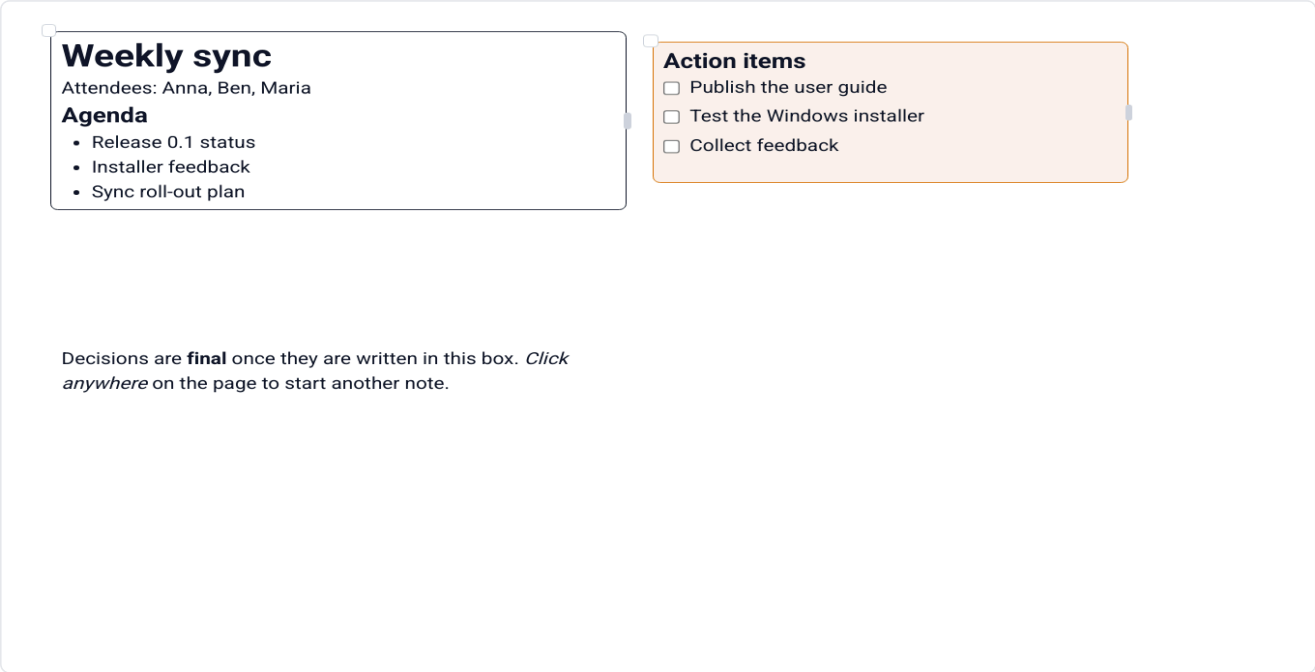


Figure: Segments placed freely on a page; the selected one shows its border and handles

10.2 Moving and resizing segments

What it does. Segments have no visible border until you select one. Then a move handle (top-left corner) and a resize handle (right edge) appear.

How to use it. Drag the small circle at the top-left corner to move a segment, and the small bar on its right edge to change its width. Text reflows to fit.

10.3 Segment colours

What it does. Colour-code segments, for example orange for action items or green for decisions. A colour gives the segment a visible border and a matching soft background.

How to use it. Right-click the segment (not on a misspelled word). Pick one of the nine **quick picks**, a colour from the **shades** grid (ten colour families, darkest at the top), one of your **recent** colours, or **More colours…** for the colour wheel (see *Page colours*). **None** removes the colour.

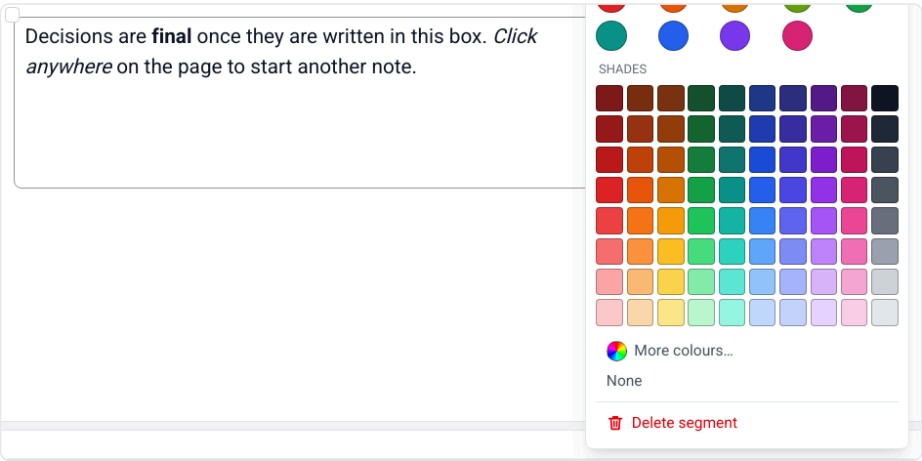


Figure: Quick picks, shades, More colours… and Delete segment

10.4 Deleting a segment, with Undo

What it does. Removes a segment in one step, whatever it contains, and gives you a few seconds to change your mind.

How to use it.

1. Right-click the segment and choose **Delete segment** (at the bottom of the menu).
2. A **Segment deleted** message appears at the bottom of the window with a bar that counts down.
3. Click **Undo** (or press `Ctrl` + `Z` while you're not typing in a segment) to bring it back exactly as it was, or click ✕ to make the deletion final straight away.

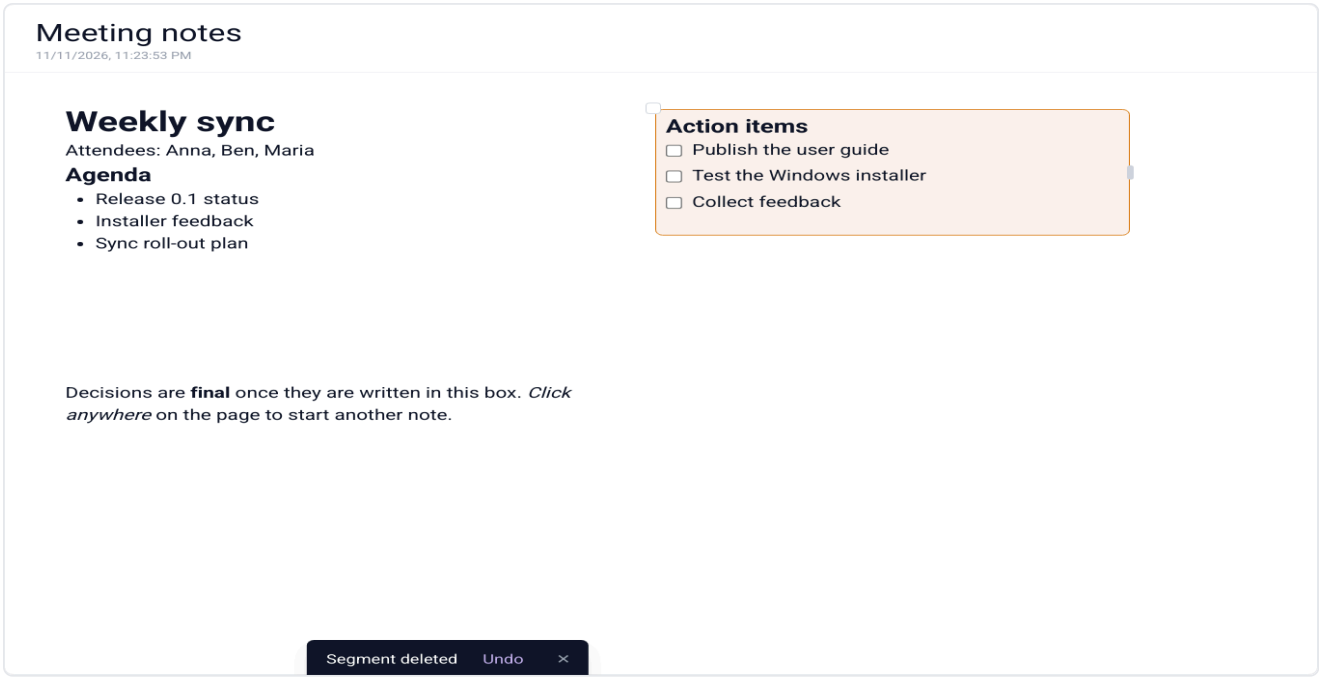


Figure: A deleted segment can be brought back with Undo

> **Tip**
> Empty segments tidy themselves away: delete all of a segment's text and click elsewhere, and it disappears, unless it has a colour.

10.5 Canvas and Linear mode

What it does. **Canvas** mode (the default) is free placement. **Linear** mode shows the same segments as one continuous document, top to bottom, which is handy for reading, reviewing or printing.

How to use it. Click **Canvas** in the status bar to switch to **Linear**, and click again to switch back. Each page remembers its mode.

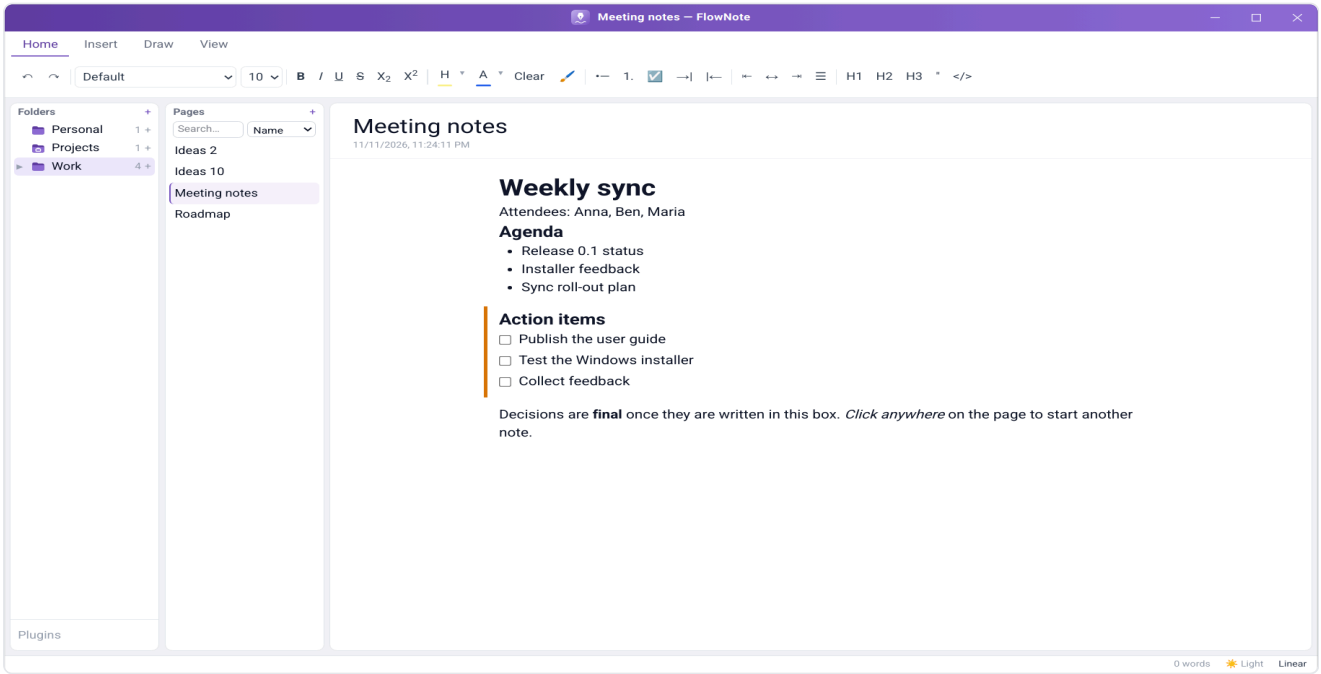


Figure: The same page in Linear mode

10.6 Spell check

What it does. Underlines misspelled words with a wavy red line as you type.

How to use it. Right-click an underlined word for suggestions, or choose **Add to Dictionary** so it isn't flagged again. Your dictionary is kept with your notes.

11. Formatting text

Select some text and use the **Home** tab of the ribbon:



Figure: The Home tab

Group	Buttons
History	Undo, Redo
Font	Font family (Default, Sans Serif, Serif, Monospace…), font size
Text style	**B**old, *I*talic, U̲nderline, ~~Strikethrough~~, subscript, superscript, Highlight, Text colour, Clear formatting, Format Painter
Lists	Bulleted list, Numbered list, Checklist, Indent, Outdent
Alignment	Left, Centre, Right, Justify
Blocks	Heading 1, Heading 2, Heading 3, Quote, Code

11.1 Fonts, text styles and colours

What it does. Choose the font family and size; apply bold, italic, underline, strikethrough, subscript and superscript; highlight text and change its colour, each from a palette.

How to use it. Select text and click a button, or use the keyboard shortcuts (chapter *Keyboard shortcuts*). The small ▾ next to Highlight and Text colour opens their colour choices.

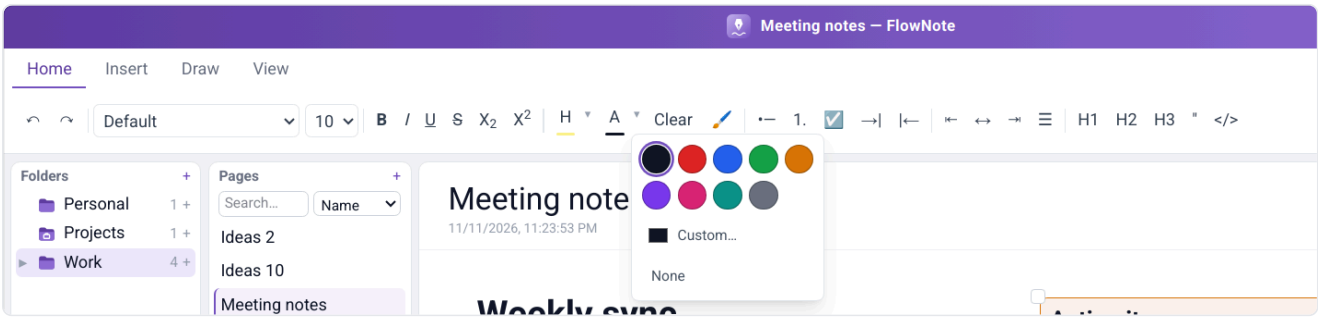


Figure: Text colour choices

11.2 Lists, checklists and alignment

What it does. Bulleted and numbered lists, checklists with tick boxes, indent and outdent for nesting, and left, centre, right or justified alignment.

How to use it. Use the Lists and Alignment groups, or `Tab` / `Shift`+`Tab` inside a list. Click a checklist box to tick it.

11.3 Headings, quotes and code

What it does. Three heading levels to structure a page, block quotes, and inline or block code.

How to use it. Put the cursor in a line and click **H1**, **H2**, **H3**, **Quote** or **Code** in the Blocks group, or use the "/" menu (next chapter).

11.4 Format Painter

What it does. Copies the formatting of one piece of text onto another, like the paintbrush in office suites.

How to use it.

1. Select text whose look you like.
2. Click the brush.
3. Select the text you want to look the same.

Double-click the brush to keep painting until you click it again.

11.5 Clear formatting, Undo and Redo

What it does. **Clear** strips all formatting from the selection. Undo and Redo step backwards and forwards through your changes.

12. Inserting content

12.1 The "/" block menu

What it does. A quick way to insert any kind of block without reaching for the ribbon: text, three heading levels, bulleted and numbered lists, checklist, quote, code block, table, blocks from plugins, and *Ask AI*.

How to use it. Type `/` at the start of a line (or after a space). Use `↑` `↓` and `Enter`, or click an item. `Esc` closes the menu.

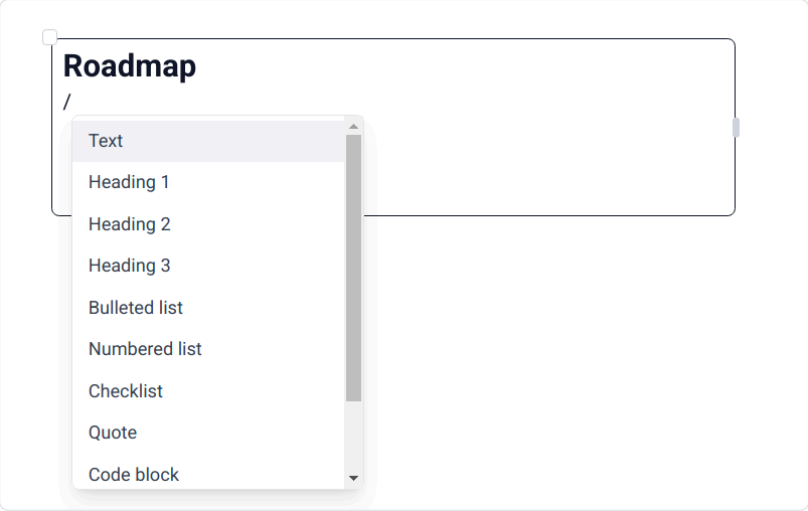


Figure: The "/" menu

12.2 Code blocks with syntax highlighting

What it does. Monospaced code blocks with colour highlighting for many programming languages. The chosen language is saved with the note.

How to use it. Insert a **Code block** from the "/" menu or the ribbon (**</>**), then choose the language from the drop-down in its top-right corner.



Figure: A code block with Python highlighting

12.3 Tables

What it does. Adds a table to a segment. The first row is a header: bold, with a coloured background (FlowNote lavender by default) and text that FlowNote keeps readable whatever header colour you choose. The other rows are shaded in alternating tints of the header colour: the row under the header gets the lightest tint, the next row one shade darker, and so on. Tables are saved, searched and synced like any other text, and show in both Canvas and Linear mode. Tables pasted from other apps keep their rows and columns.

How to insert a table.

1. Click in a segment where the table should go.
2. Type `/` and choose **Table…**, or open the **Insert** tab and click **Insert table**.
3. In the grid, move the mouse (or the arrow keys) to choose the number of rows and columns, then click (or press `Enter`).
4. Type into the header cell. Press `Tab` to move to the next cell and `Shift` + `Tab` to go back.

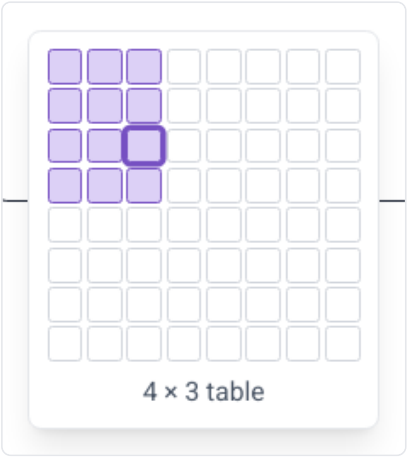


Figure: Choosing the table size

Weekly shop

Item	Qty	Price
Apples	6	2.40
Bread	1	1.80
Milk	2	1.98

Figure: A table with a header row and shaded rows

How to change a table. Put the cursor in a cell and use the table tools on the **Insert** tab. They act on the row or column the cursor is in:

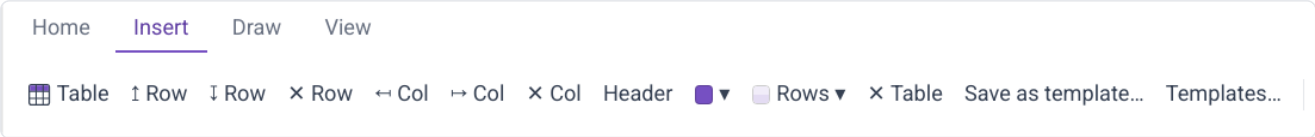


Figure: The table tools on the Insert tab

Button	What it does
↥ Row / ↧ Row	Insert a row above / below
× Row	Delete the row
↤ Col / ↦ Col	Insert a column to the left / right
× Col	Delete the column
Header	Turn the header row on or off
Header colour (●▾)	Choose the header row's background colour from the swatches, or **Custom…** for any colour. **None** removes it.
Rows ▾	Choose the colours of the other rows (see below)
× Table	Delete the whole table

Drag the border between two columns to make a column wider or narrower.

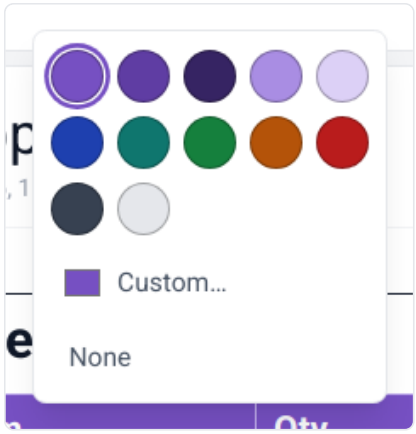


Figure: Choosing a header colour

How to colour the rows. Put the cursor in the table and click **Rows ▾** on the **Insert** tab. Under **Apply to**, choose:

- **All rows** to change the alternating shading. Pick a colour and the rows alternate between its lightest tint and one shade darker. **Match header colour** goes back to following the header (the default; the shading then changes whenever the header colour does), and **No shading** leaves the rows plain.
- **This row** to give the row the cursor is in a colour of its own, over the shading. Select several cells first to colour all their rows at once. FlowNote picks a readable text colour for it. **Use table shading** removes the row's own colour.

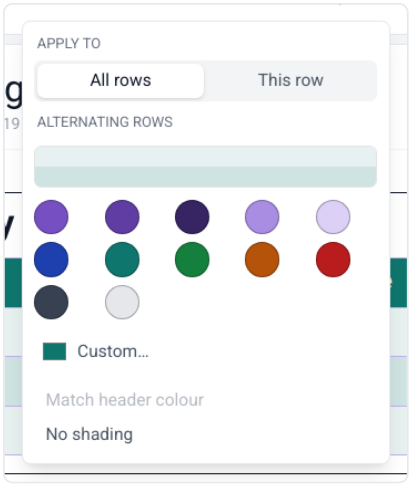


Figure: The Row colours menu

Weekly shop

Item	Qty	Price
Apples	6	2.40
Bread	1	1.80
Milk	2	1.98

Figure: Shaded rows, and one row in its own colour

> **Note**
> The shading is a see-through tint, so it also works on a coloured page, inside a coloured segment and in the dark theme.

12.4 Table templates

What it does. Saves a table's layout so you can reuse it: the number of rows and columns, column widths, header text and header colour, the row colours, and, if you want, the text in the other cells too. Templates are available on every page. An inserted template is an independent copy, so changing it doesn't change the template.

How to save a template.

1. Put the cursor anywhere in the table.
2. On the **Insert** tab, click **Save as template…**.
3. Type a name. Tick **Include cell contents** if the body text should be saved too (it's off by default, so only the structure and header are kept).
4. Click **Save**. If a template with that name already exists, FlowNote asks before replacing it.

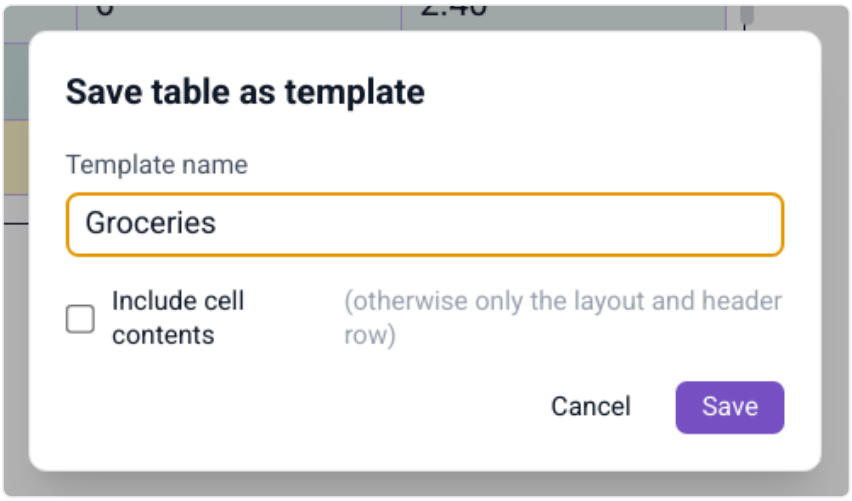


Figure: Saving a table as a template

How to insert a template. Open the table picker (**Insert table**, or `/` → **Table…**) and click the template under **From template**. Or type `/table` followed by part of the template's name, for example `/table groc`, and press `Enter` on the

match.

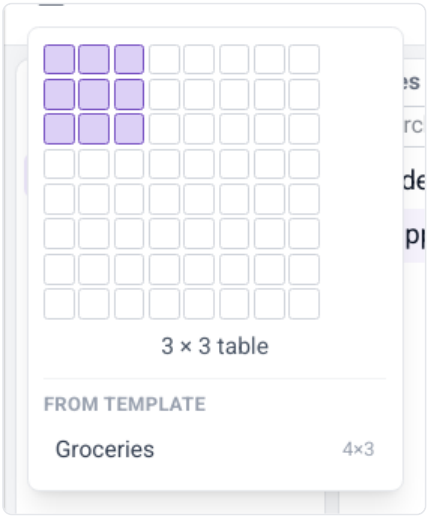


Figure: Templates in the table picker

How to manage templates. On the **Insert** tab, click **Templates…** to preview, rename or delete your templates. Tables already in your notes are not affected.

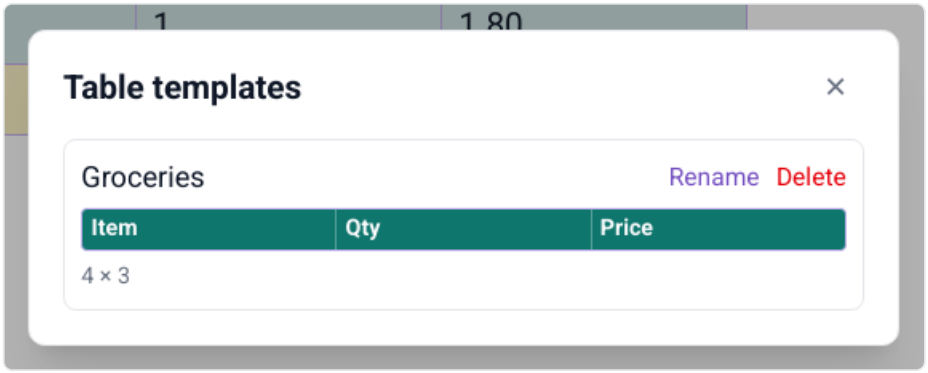


Figure: The Table templates window

> **Note**
> Templates are kept on this computer. They aren't synced to your other devices yet.

12.5 Pictures and file attachments

What it does. Paste files and pictures straight into a note. Pictures are shown inline. Other files can be attached as a compact chip (icon, name, size) that opens in its usual app, or embedded as an inline preview. Files are copied into FlowNote's own storage, so notes keep working if the original moves.

How to use it.

1. Copy a file or picture, for example in your file manager, or take a screenshot.
2. Click in a segment and press `Ctrl` + `V`.
3. Screenshots and copied images are embedded straight away. For other files choose **Attach as file** or **Embed in note**.
4. Drag an embedded item's corner to resize it.

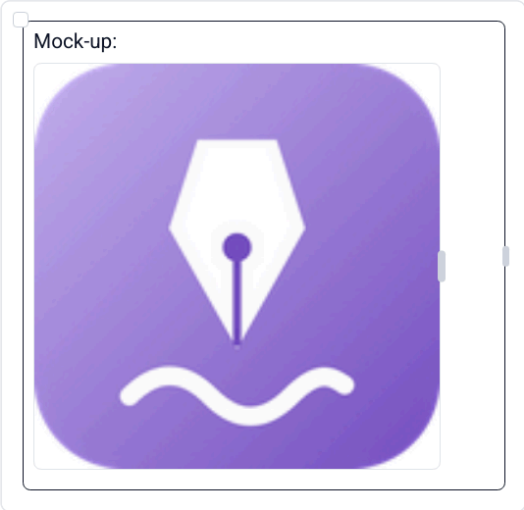


Figure: An embedded picture

13. Drawing and handwriting

What it does. Draw or handwrite anywhere on a page, over and around your text: sketches, diagrams, arrows, signatures. Ink is saved with the page.

How to use it.

1. Open the **Draw** tab.
2. Choose **Pen** (solid line), **Marker** (translucent, like a highlighter) or **Eraser** (removes strokes), and one of the colour swatches.
3. Draw with the mouse, a touchpad or a pen tablet.
4. Switch back to the **Home** tab to type again. Your drawing stays on the page.

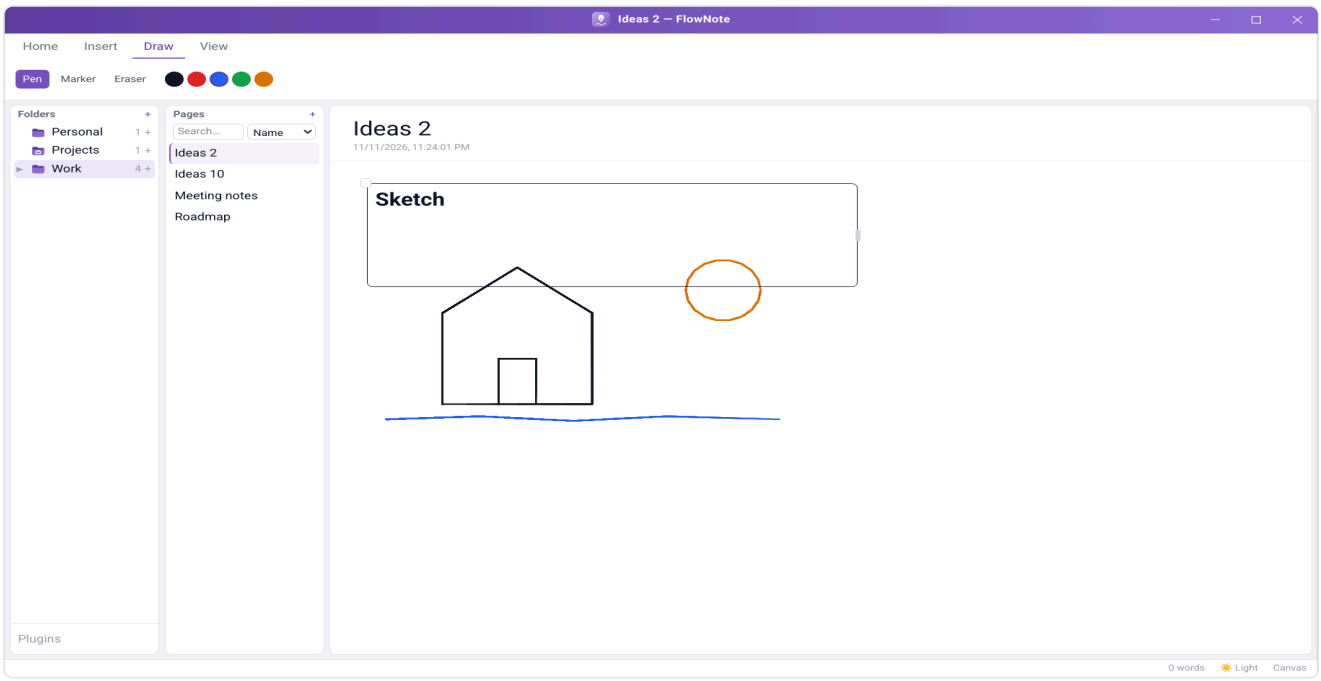


Figure: Drawing with the pen in different colours

14. Finding notes

What it does. Finds pages in two ways. **Name** matches page names. **Contents** searches the full text of every page in every folder, using a fast full-text index kept up to date as you type.

How to use it.

1. Type in the search box at the top of the Pages panel.
2. Pick **Name** or **Contents** from the drop-down next to it.
3. Click a result to open it. Clear the search box to go back to the folder's page list.

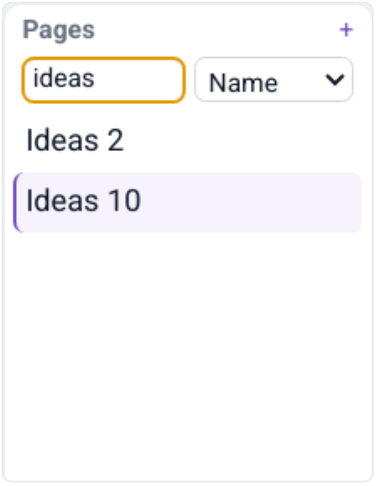


Figure: Searching by name

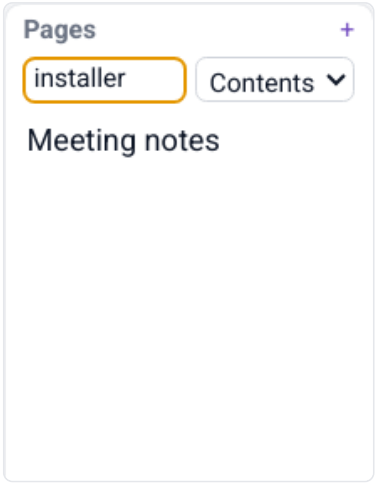


Figure: Searching by contents

15. Making FlowNote look the way you like

15.1 Light and dark theme

What it does. A full dark theme for evening work, a light theme, or *System* to follow your computer's setting automatically.

How to use it. Click the theme button in the status bar to cycle **System** → **Light** → **Dark**.

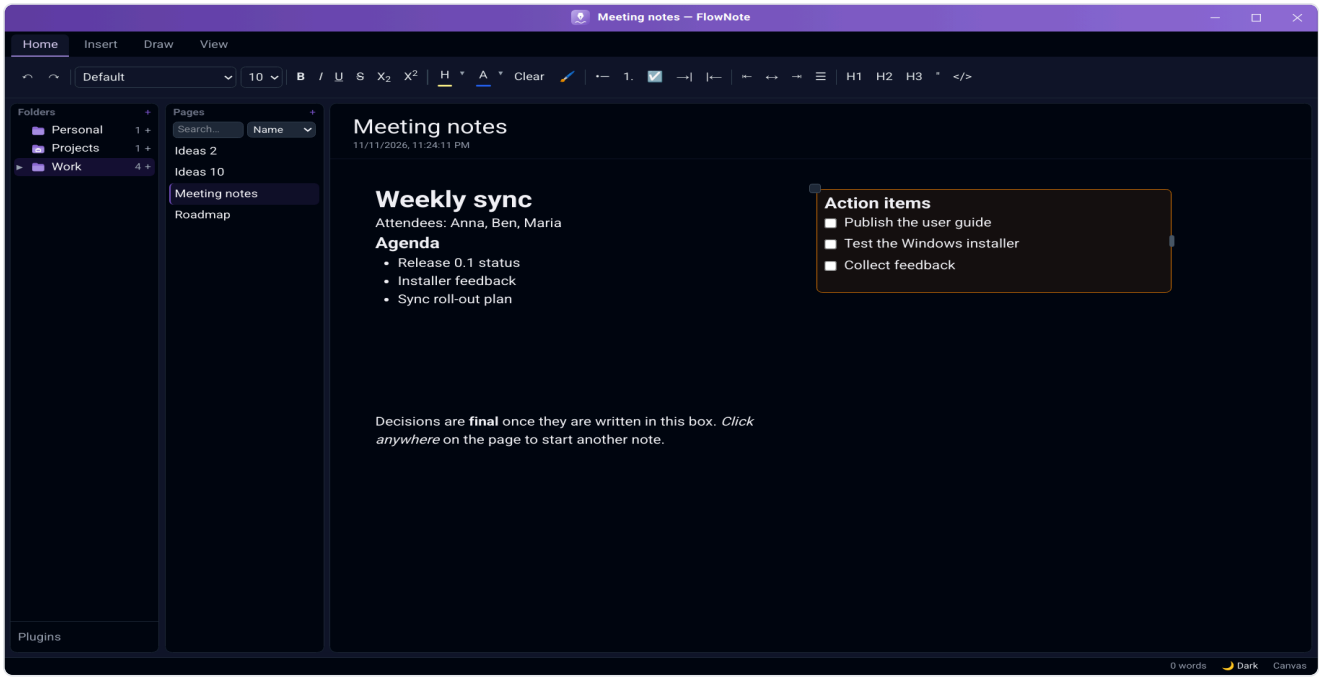


Figure: Dark theme

15.2 Page colours

What it does. Gives a page a background colour: a paper tone (Ivory, Sepia, Cream, Mint, Sky, Lavender, Rose, Grey), any of 100 shades, or any colour at all from the colour wheel. Set it for one page, or as the default for all pages. Dark colours work too: the text turns light to stay readable. Page colours show in the light theme.

How to use it.

1. On the **View** tab, click **Page colour**.
2. Under **Apply to**, choose **This page** or **All pages** (the default for every page that doesn't have its own colour).
3. Pick a colour from **Paper**, **Shades** (ten colour families, darkest at the top) or **Recent**, or click **More colours…** for the colour wheel.
4. **Use default** (for this page) or **White** (for all pages) removes the colour.

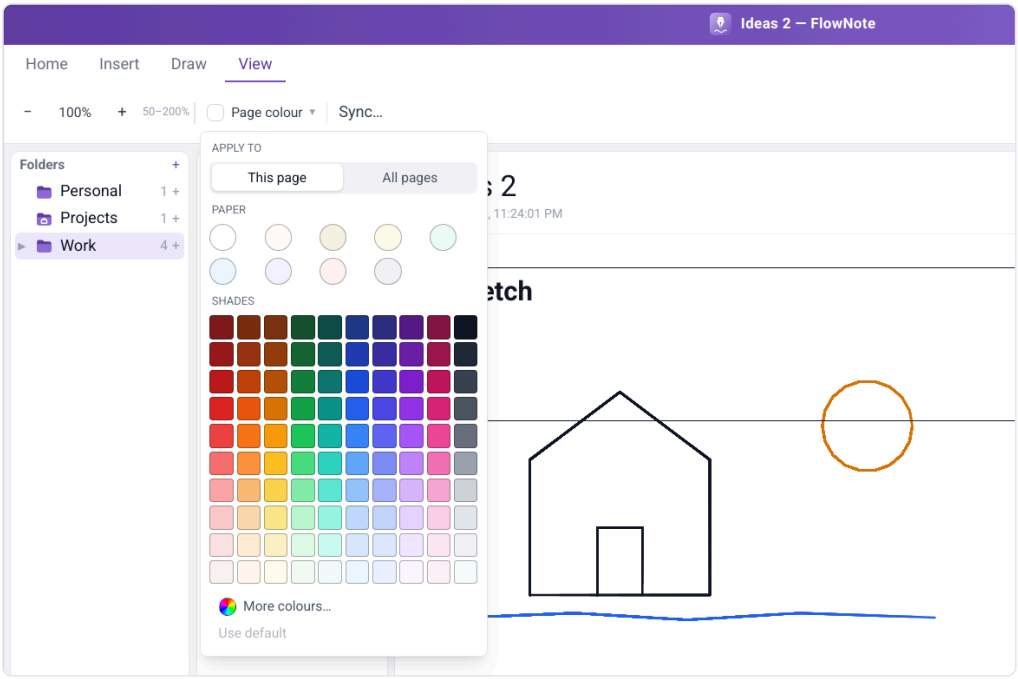


Figure: The Page colour menu on the View tab

The colour wheel. Drag across the wheel (or use the arrow keys) to choose the colour, use the **Brightness** slider to make it lighter or darker, or type an exact hex code such as `#7dd3fc`. The two squares compare the current and the new colour. Nothing changes until you click **Apply**, which also adds the colour to *Recent*; **Cancel** goes back to the palette.

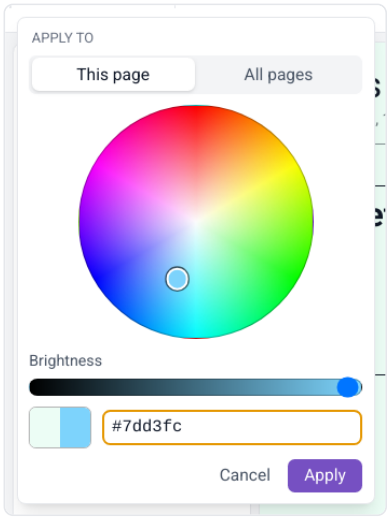


Figure: The colour wheel

15.3 Contrast assistant

What it does. Watches for coloured text that becomes hard to read on the page colour you picked, and offers to fix it. Nothing changes unless you ask.

How to use it. When the notice appears, choose **Adjust** (recolour the affected text so it's readable), **Show me** (briefly highlight it) or **Keep** (leave it and don't ask again for this colour).

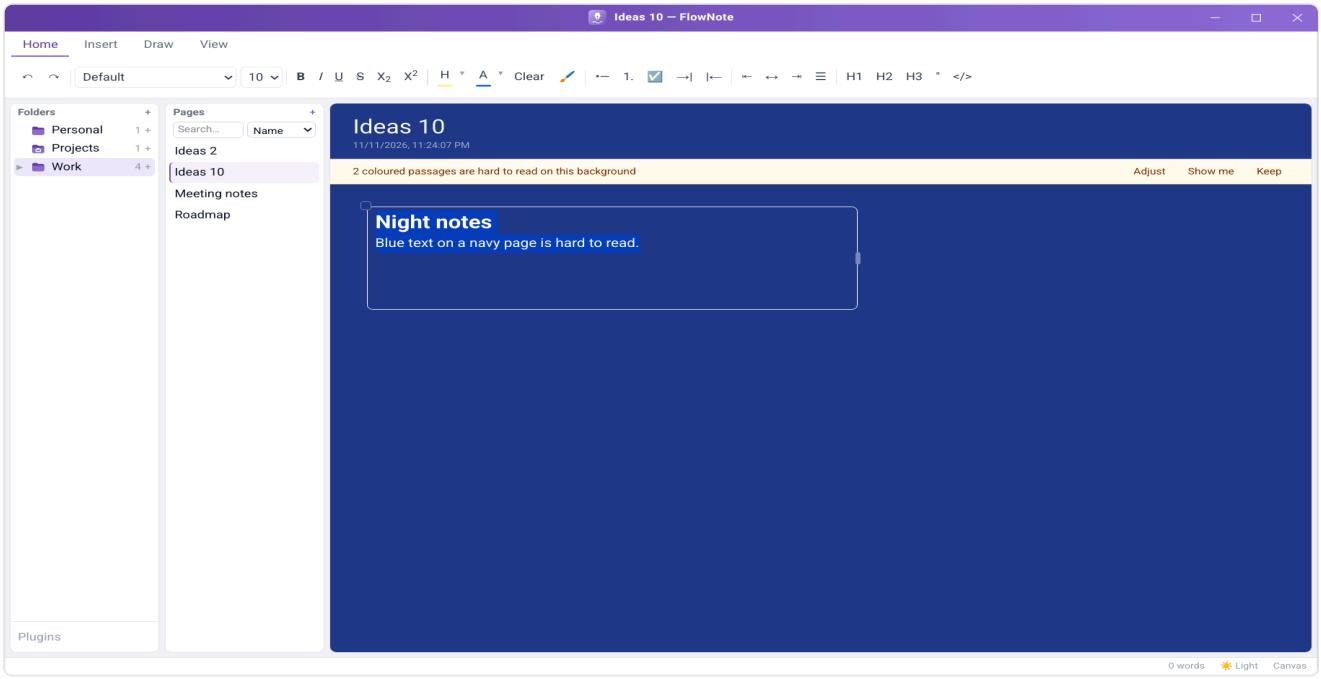


Figure: The contrast notice on a dark page…

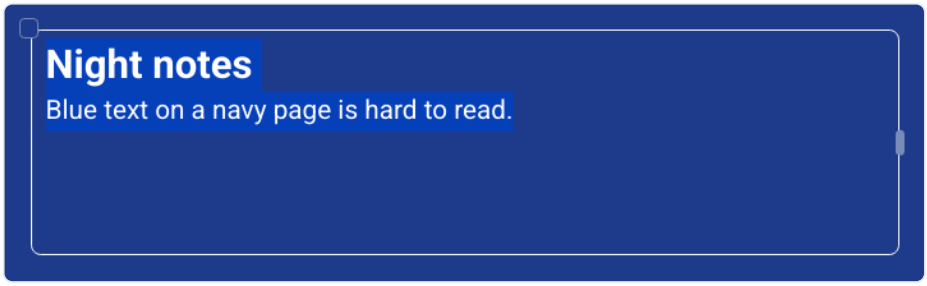


Figure: …and the same text after Adjust

15.4 **Zoom and resizable panels**

What it does. Zoom the canvas from 50% to 200%, and give each panel the room you need.

How to use it. On the **View** tab, use zoom out (−), zoom in (+), or the reset button that shows the current zoom level. Drag the gap between the folder, page and editor panels to resize them; a lavender bar shows when the pointer is over it. Double-click the gap to go back to the default width.

15.5 **Status bar**

What it does. Shows the sync state, the theme switch, and the page's editing mode (Canvas or Linear). Each one is a button.

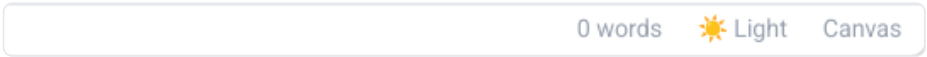


Figure: The status bar

16. AI writing assistant

What it does. Drafts text for you from a prompt: summaries, outlines, rewrites, ideas. You choose the AI service, and nothing is sent anywhere until you set one up and ask. Supported services:

Service	Needs	Where your text goes
Ollama (local)	Ollama running on your computer	Nowhere. It stays on your computer
Claude (Anthropic)	An API key	Anthropic
Gemini (Google)	An API key	Google
OpenAI	An API key	OpenAI
Other OpenAI-compatible service	Its address (and key, if it needs one)	That service

How to set it up.

1. On the **Insert** tab, click ⚙ (AI settings).
2. Click **Add provider** and pick a service.
3. Check the model name, paste an API key if the service needs one, and save.
4. Add more providers if you like, and mark one as the default.

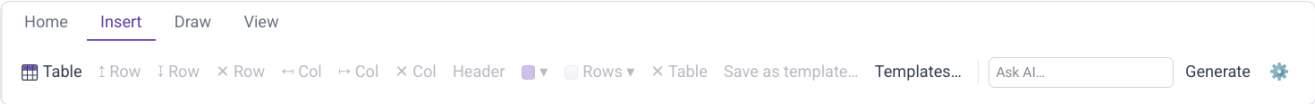


Figure: The Insert tab: Ask AI, Generate and ⚙ (AI settings) on the right

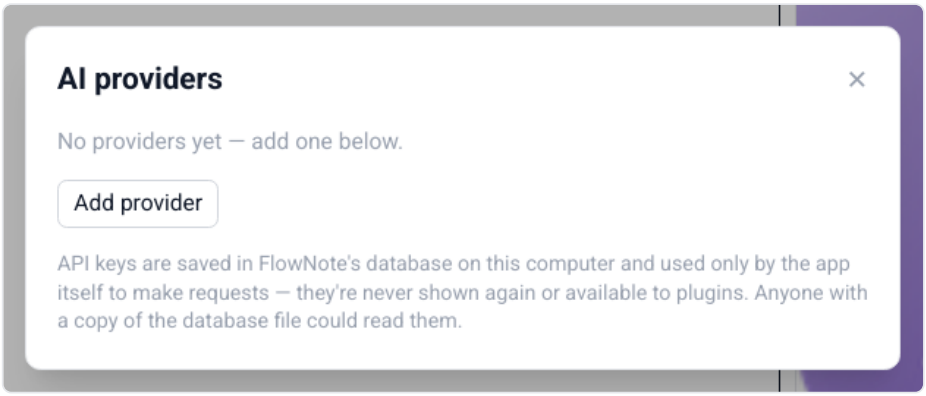


Figure: AI settings

How to use it.

1. Type a request in the **Ask AI…** box on the Insert tab and click **Generate**, or type `/` in a segment and choose **Ask AI…**.
2. The answer streams into the segment as a tinted draft. **Stop** ends a long answer early.
3. Choose **Keep** (`Ctrl` + `Enter`), **Discard** (`Esc`) or **Try again**.

> **Note**
> API keys are stored in FlowNote's database on your computer and used only to make your requests. They're never shown again and are not available to plugins.

17. Plugins

What it does. Plugins add new kinds of blocks to FlowNote. Each plugin runs in its own sandbox and can only do what its manifest declares (for example, store its own data). The first plugin, **Spreadsheet**, adds a live grid you can type numbers and text into, inside any segment.

How to install a plugin.

1. Click **Plugins** at the bottom of the Folders panel.
2. Click **Install…**, paste the plugin's manifest, and click **Install**.
3. The plugin appears in the list. Untick *Enabled* to switch it off, or click *Uninstall* to remove it.

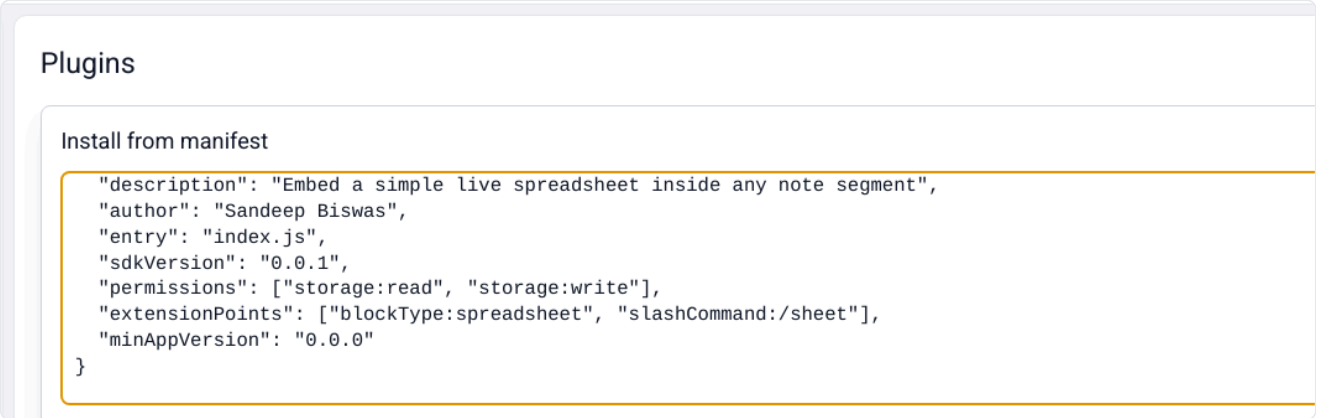


Figure: Installing a plugin from its manifest

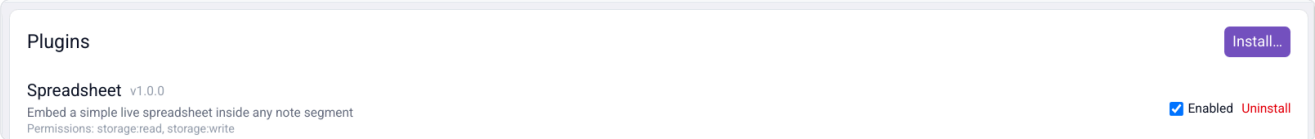


Figure: The Spreadsheet plugin, installed and enabled

How to use a plugin block. Type `/` in a segment. Plugin blocks appear in the menu after the built-in ones. Choose **Spreadsheet** to insert a grid.

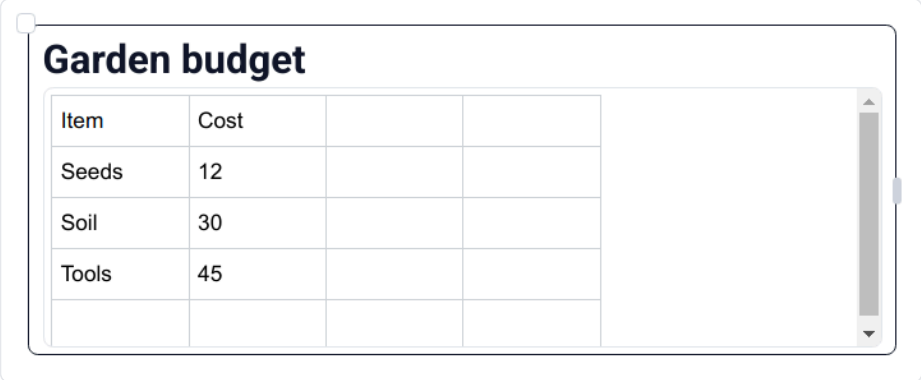


Figure: A Spreadsheet block in a note

> **Note**
> **Known issue on Windows:** in this version, plugins don't load in the Windows app, so *Spreadsheet* doesn't appear in the "/" menu there. Plugins work on Linux. A fix is planned.

> **Tip**
> Developers can build their own plugins with the FlowNote plugin SDK (`@flownote/sdk`) and the `@flownote/cli` scaffolding tool in the FlowNote source repository.

18. Keeping your notes safe

18.1 Where your notes are stored

	Linux	Windows
Notes database	`~/.config/@flownote/electron/flownote.sqlite3`	`%APPDATA%\com.sandeep.flownote\flownote.sqlite3`
Attached files	`~/.config/@flownote/electron/attachments/`	`%APPDATA%\com.sandeep.flownote\attachments\`
Copies made before syncing	`~/.config/@flownote/electron/backups/`	`%APPDATA%\com.sandeep.flownote\backups\`

To make a manual backup, close FlowNote and copy that folder somewhere safe (see *Backing up your notes* in Part 1).

18.2 Backup & Sync

What it does. Keeps an **end-to-end encrypted** copy of your notes in a place you choose, and keeps several computers in step. Your notes are encrypted on your computer before they leave it, so only your devices can read them, not the cloud provider. FlowNote works offline first: changes sync when you're back online.

- **Your own storage.** OneDrive (kept in *Apps/FlowNote*), Google Drive (a *FlowNote* folder), or any folder on your computer, which works with Dropbox, Syncthing, a USB drive or a network share.
- **Safety copies.** FlowNote saves a copy of your notes before it applies changes from other devices.

How to set it up.

1. On the **View** tab, click **Sync…**.
2. Choose where to sync: **OneDrive**, **Google Drive**, or **A folder on this computer**.
3. For OneDrive or Google Drive, click **Continue to … sign-in** and sign in with your browser.
4. Choose a **passphrase**. Use the same passphrase on every device you want to sync.
5. Give this device a name, so you can tell your devices apart.
6. On your other computers, choose the same place and enter the same passphrase.

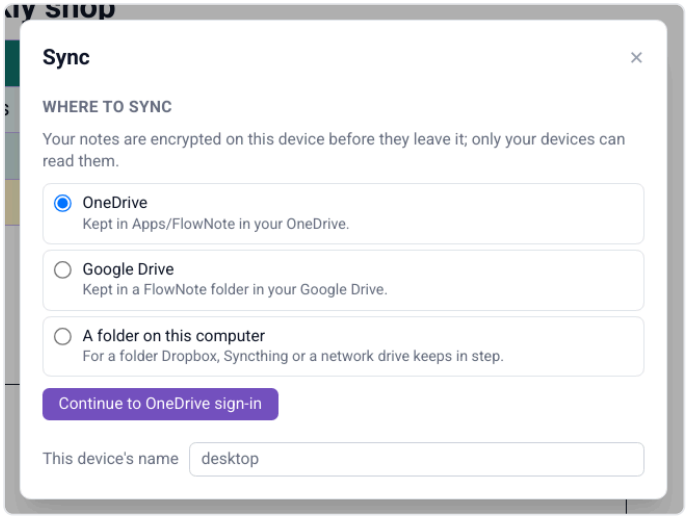


Figure: Sync settings

> **Important**
> Keep your passphrase somewhere safe. Without it, nobody (including you) can read the synced copy. Your notes on this computer are unaffected.

18.3 Sync status

What it does. The status bar always shows where things stand: *Synced*, *Syncing…*, *Not synced yet*, *Sync needs attention* or *Sync error*. Click it to open the sync settings.

18.4 Conflict handling

What it does. If the same segment was edited on two devices at the same time, nothing is lost: FlowNote keeps both versions side by side and marks the other device's copy with a badge.

How to use it. Keep what you need from each version and delete the rest.

18.5 Mass-deletion safeguard

What it does. If another device deletes a large part of your notes at once (by accident, or because something went wrong), FlowNote holds those deletions and asks first.

How to use it. **Apply** carries the deletions out here, **Not now** hides the question for this session, and **Details** opens the sync settings.

19. Keyboard shortcuts

These work while you're typing in a segment.

Action	Shortcut
Bold / Italic / Underline	`Ctrl` + `B` / `Ctrl` + `I` / `Ctrl` + `U`
Strikethrough	`Ctrl` + `Shift` + `S`
Subscript / Superscript	`Ctrl` + `,` / `Ctrl` + `.`

Action	Shortcut
Highlight	`Ctrl` + `Shift` + `H`
Heading 1 / 2 / 3	`Ctrl` + `Alt` + `1` / `2` / `3`
Bulleted list / Numbered list / Checklist	`Ctrl` + `Shift` + `8` / `7` / `9`
Indent / Outdent a list item	`Tab` / `Shift` + `Tab`
Next / previous table cell	`Tab` / `Shift` + `Tab`
Quote	`Ctrl` + `Shift` + `B`
Code block	`Ctrl` + `Alt` + `C`
Insert block menu	`/`
Insert a table template	`/` then `table` and part of its name
Undo / Redo	`Ctrl` + `Z` / `Ctrl` + `Shift` + `Z` (or `Ctrl` + `Y`)
Undo deleting a segment (while the message shows)	`Ctrl` + `Z`, when you're not typing in a segment
Keep / discard an AI draft	`Ctrl` + `Enter` / `Esc`
Select all text in a segment	`Ctrl` + `A`
Paste a picture or file	`Ctrl` + `V`
Close a menu or dialog	`Esc`

20. Troubleshooting

For problems while installing or uninstalling, see *Solving installation problems* in Part 1.

Problem	What to do
Typing after clicking the page does nothing	Click inside the new segment first, then type.
"File name must start with a letter"	Page names can start with any letter, lowercase or capital, but not with a number or a symbol. Put a word first, e.g. *Draft 2* instead of *2nd draft*.
I deleted a segment by mistake	Click **Undo** in the message at the bottom of the window, or press `Ctrl` + `Z`, before it disappears (a few seconds).
The table buttons on the Insert tab are greyed out	They act on the table the cursor is in. Click inside a table cell first.
My table template isn't on my other computer	Templates aren't synced yet. Save the template again on the other computer.
The Spreadsheet plugin doesn't appear in the "/" menu on Windows	A known issue in this version: plugins don't load yet in the Windows app. It works on Linux. A fix is planned.
On Linux the window has black corners, or its edges can't be dragged to resize it	Your desktop isn't drawing see-through windows. Start FlowNote with square corners from a terminal: `flownote --square-window` (or set `FLOWNOTE_SQUARE_WINDOW=1`).
Sync says it needs attention	Open **View** → **Sync…** to see what's wrong. Often you just need to sign in again.

Problem	What to do
FlowNote takes several seconds to start (Linux, just-for-me install)	Install FUSE 2: `sudo apt install libfuse2t64` (or `libfuse2`), then run the installer again.

21. Frequently asked questions

Does FlowNote need an internet connection?

No. Everything works offline. The internet is only used for Backup & Sync to OneDrive or Google Drive, and for AI services you choose to set up.

Will uninstalling delete my notes?

Not unless you ask it to. Both the Linux and Windows uninstallers keep your notes by default.

How do I move my notes to a new computer?

Set up Backup & Sync on both computers with the same passphrase. Or close FlowNote, copy the data folder (see *Where your notes are stored*) to the same place on the new computer, and start FlowNote there.

Can I use FlowNote without segments, like a normal document?

Yes. Switch the page to **Linear** mode in the status bar.

Is my data sent to an AI service?

Only if you add an AI provider yourself (Insert → ⚙), and only the text you ask it about. With *Ollama (local)*, nothing leaves your computer.